Chemical peel science — how peels really work
కెమికల్ పీల్ సైన్స్

TODAY'S OBJECTIVES · ఈ రోజు లక్ష్యాలు

- Explain peel depth, pH and free acid value in your own words
- Match peel type to concern and Fitzpatrick type
- Set up a complete, safe peel station

THEORY · థియరీ

What a peel does

A controlled chemical injury removes dead and damaged cells and triggers repair — faster turnover, more collagen, more even pigment. Depth decides result and risk: very superficial (stratum corneum) = glow, minimal downtime; superficial (full epidermis) = pigmentation, acne; medium (papillary dermis) = scars, deeper lines — doctor territory in Indian skin.

pH, concentration and free acid

A 30% glycolic peel at pH 3.5 is much gentler than 30% at pH 1.8. Free acid value tells you how much acid is actually active. Never judge a peel by percentage alone. Time on skin is your second dial — start with the shortest recommended time on a first session and build up.

Indian-skin rules

Fitzpatrick IV–V: prefer superficial peels, prime the skin 2–4 weeks before with a gentle routine, avoid sun for 5 days after, use strict sunscreen, space sessions 3–4 weeks apart. Aggressive peels on dark skin cause PIH that takes months to clear and destroys the client's trust.

Hands-on today

- Identify 6 peel bottles: acid, %, pH, indication, neutraliser required or not
- Set up a peel station: peel, neutraliser, fan, cold compress, timer, gauze, gloves
- Do a patch test behind the ear on a volunteer and read it at 24 h

Safety & contraindications

- Always have the neutraliser open and ready before the first drop of peel
- Never peel over active infection, open wounds, or recent waxing/threading (48 h)

KEY POINTS TO REMEMBER · గుర్తుంచుకోవలసినవి

- Depth = result + risk
- pH and free acid > percentage
- Start with shortest time
- 3–4 weeks between sessions

Homework

Make a peel comparison chart: glycolic, lactic, mandelic, salicylic, TCA — depth, indication, downtime.

Grooming & professional tip

Confidence in peels comes from preparation, not bravado. A prepared station is what lets you stay calm if skin frosts early.

SELF-CHECK · సెల్ఫ్ చెక్

- Did I follow hygiene and consent for every client today?
- Which step did I need help with — and what will I drill tonight?
- Did I write my records and settings before leaving?

Trainer sign: _____ Trainee sign: _____

MY NOTES · నా నోట్స్